

Plastic banknotes

- **What?** Australian dollar notes
- **Who?** Reserve Bank of Australia
- **Where and when?** Australia, 1988

Traditionally, banknotes have been made of a cotton-paper mix. In the 1980s, a group of institutions in Australia began looking at alternatives and, in 1988, the country's national bank issued the first plastic banknotes. They are highly durable, and are also much harder to forge.

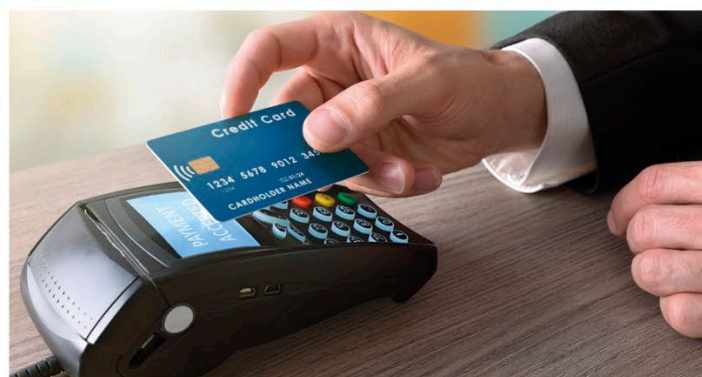


Australian 100 dollar plastic banknotes

Internet banking

- **What?** Banking online
- **Who?** Stanford Federal Credit Union
- **Where and when?** US, 1994

In 1981, the earliest versions of what would become online banking began in New York City when four banks (Citibank, Chase Manhattan, Chemical Bank, and Manufacturers Hanover) made home-banking available to their customers. People had to use videotex—an early and not very user-friendly system combining televisions, keyboards, and modems. In 1994, with the spread of the Internet, Stanford Federal Credit Union became the first institution to offer online banking to all of its customers.



Contactless card

- **What?** UPass
- **Who?** Seoul Bus Transport Association
- **Where and when?** South Korea, 1995

In 1983, the American engineer Charles Watson patented the radio frequency identification device (RFID), which was like an electronic identity chip. This technology opened the door to contactless payment. In South Korea in 1995, the Seoul Bus Transport Association implemented the first large-scale use of contactless cards for the city's commuters. Now, many banks have adopted this payment system.

Smartphone payment

- **What?** ApplePay
- **Who?** Apple
- **Where and when?** US, 2014

To add to the convenience of credit and debit cards and online banking, we can now increasingly pay for goods and services using smartphone apps. Wallets and purses may soon be a thing of the past. Sweden is a leader in this technology, and is very close to being a cashless society—in 2016, only one percent of the value of all payments made there used coins or banknotes.



▼ **COFFEE TO GO**
Fast “smart” payments are useful for smaller purchases.